NEW BEDFORD HIGH SCHOOL · SCIENCE DEPARTMENT PLC

Draft the Writing Benchmark & Anticipate Student Thinking

A focused first step in the Science Literacy Learning Cycle

MONDAY, NOVEMBER 2, 2026 | **45 MINUTES** | **GRADES 9–12 SCIENCE**

TODAY'S OUTCOME

Leave with: one standards-aligned task, a first-draft writing benchmark, the beginning of an answer key, anticipated student responses, and one refinement question for Tuesday's District PD.

TODAY'S PLC PLAN

0–8 MIN	**Launch & select the task** Choose one upcoming task and name the standard, science practice, language demand, and evidence of learning it should reveal.	**PRODUCT** **Task + standard**
8–25 MIN	**Complete it as a learner** Work through the task independently. Capture the claim, evidence or data, reasoning, vocabulary, and organization a strong response requires.	**PRODUCT** **First-draft benchmark**
25–37 MIN	**Calibrate & begin the answer key** Compare drafts, combine the strongest elements, and identify three or four nonnegotiable indicators of quality.	**PRODUCT** **Shared mastery bar**
37–45 MIN	**Anticipate student thinking** Name likely strengths and needs, note an initial pacing decision, and record the refinement question the team will carry into Tuesday.	**PRODUCT** **PD-ready packet**

BRING

An upcoming task, investigation, data-analysis prompt, model, science article, or lab conclusion; its related standard; and the Lesson Internalization Tool.

PROTOCOL CONNECTION

Clarify the learning goal and mastery bar, anticipate responses, and plan access and pacing without lowering cognitive demand.

Planning anchor: The benchmark is a tool for planning and feedback. It is not a ranking of students, teachers, classes, or courses.